Taehun Kim

Staff Data Scientist 10 years in data science

Coupang Fintech / Pay | May 2022 - present

NYSE-listed / Fortune 500 #132 (2026) / 24.7M Product Commerce active customers (Q2 2026)

I build AI products for financial services, combining hands-on modeling with product decisions, risk trade-offs, and business evaluation. At Coupang, I lead work across lending, fraud prevention, and GenAI tools - from defining the problem to launch, adoption, and ongoing improvement.

> My focus: deciding what is worth building, developing the solution, and making it useful in day-to-day decisions.

PREVIOUS EXPERIENCE

Kimberly-Clark | Senior Data Scientist

D2C prediction and recommendation models; global marketing data standardization.

IBM | Data Scientist

Automotive-parts forecasting POC with data scientists in the UK, Germany, and Japan.

Hana Institute of Technology | Data Scientist

Small-business credit scoring, robo-advisory, and marketing automation.

AI and data research arm of Hana Financial Group, one of Korea's four major financial groups.

EDUCATION

UC San Diego

Master's degree

Peking University

Bachelor's degree

TEACHING, WRITING & RECOGNITION

Adjunct Professor | Ajou University

Mar 2025 - present

Graduate AI program - Understanding Financial AI / AI System Design

Author | Financial AI in Practice | Manning

Kaggle Notebooks Grandmaster

LANGUAGES

Korean / Native

Mandarin Chinese / Native

English / Working proficiency

From business problems to working products.

CATEGORY	PROJECT	BUSINESS OBJECTIVE	MODELING / ARCHITECTURE	MY OWNERSHIP	BUSINESS IMPACT / EVALUATION
Operations	**AI analytics platform** Ongoing	Enable self-service analytics; free BA capacity.	Text-to-SQL; graph-structured SQL / DAG knowledge; RAG, MCP, vLLM.	Prioritized use cases; led development, rollout, training, and feedback.	**~70% fewer ad hoc BA tickets;** continuous iteration. Target: >=80% task completion within 3 turns.
Lending	**MCA: launch risk framework**	Launch seller lending without repayment history.	Stop-selling proxies; sales-based repayment simulation; shared seller feature layer.	Defined proxy labels and risk tiers; shaped lending decisions with policy teams.	Enabled cold-start launch with expected loss within the agreed target range.
Lending	**MCA: forecasts & early risk**	Maximize risk-adjusted profitability within risk appetite.	Transformer sales forecasts, P10/P50/P90; early-risk and seller-collapse models.	Shaped limit policies using forecast quantiles, risk signals, and seller tiers.	**Estimated ~10% increase in risk-adjusted margin (RAM)** within the agreed risk appetite.
Lending	**BNPL scoring**	Control delinquency using platform behavior.	Application and behavioral scores; bureau data and platform behavior.	Built both scoring models and risk tiers for BNPL operations.	**Delinquency ~7% to <3%;** behavior-only models sustained roughly 3%.
Lending	**Small-business credit** Hana Institute of Technology	Improve small-business risk differentiation.	ML application scoring with property, card, and other alternative data.	Developed scoring models and translated scores into credit grades.	**AUC improved from the 0.70s to the low 0.80s** against bureau benchmarks.
Fraud	**Payment FDS / KR / TW**	Protect payments while keeping manual review manageable.	Supervised / anomaly models; capacity simulations, reason codes, urgent queues.	Replaced rule-only routing with risk-ranked reviews and capacity-based thresholds.	**Review volume ~90% lower** in an overloaded queue; urgent cases prioritized.
Fraud	**Overseas-card acceptance**	Manage cold-start risk for overseas cards.	Country-level risk signals; surrogate models; chargeback monitoring.	Set initial thresholds and iterated with emerging fraud / chargeback data.	**Chargeback rate <0.3%** - less than one-tenth of the ~3% reference benchmark.
Fraud	**TW multi-account abuse**	Detect networks bypassing promotional purchase limits.	Neo4j and Louvain communities; daily to 6-hour / 3-hour monitoring.	Introduced graph detection; connected investigation workflows with account-policy discussions.	Observed multi-account coupon abuse was largely eliminated.
Fraud	**GenAI review assistance** Ongoing / experimental	Reduce investigation effort while retaining novel-fraud sensitivity.	LLM review with graph context; guided and open-pattern review paths.	Designed review assistance and experiments on prompt anchoring and novel patterns.	*Review effort and novel-pattern recall under evaluation; ongoing iteration.*
Investing	**Robo-advisor** Hana Institute of Technology	Launch an ML-driven investment product.	US ETF direction prediction and portfolio optimization.	Built prediction models; contributed to portfolio design and validation.	Passed the national robo-advisor testbed and reached product launch.
Marketing	**AutoML automation** Hana Institute of Technology	Automate repeatable marketing analytics.	AutoML-based predictive modeling tools.	Contributed modeling and automation for marketing workflows.	Automated parts of the marketing analysis workflow.

MCA: merchant cash advance / BNPL: buy now, pay later / FDS: fraud detection system / BA: business analyst. Rounded project observations; RAM increase is an estimate. The ~3% chargeback comparison is a project reference benchmark. Targets and experimental work are labeled.